

Grammar/Comp





About the Course

Students spend two lessons each week deepening their understanding of the parts of speech. During the other two lessons, students grow their writing skills with composition assignments from their books. Throughout the year, they explore literary concepts such as point of view and experiment with multiple forms of writing, including letters, descriptions, short accounts, and poetry.

This topic is included in the following course(s): Language Study: Grade 8

Grammar/Comp: Grade 8

These lessons, combined with the writing practice students continue to gain through written narrations, reinforce concepts and build fluency with various types of written forms.

NARRATION vs. COMPOSITION

As students begin to have more formal composition assignments in addition to written narrations, it's important to consider the difference between the two. Both narrations and compositions build students' skills in writing. The focus in narrations is on building written fluency by "telling back" the reading in written/typed form (and students are free to experiment with various ways to do this or not, as interested). The focus in composition assignments is to give them accountability and structure to practice specific skills in one or more types of writing.

Sometimes this means that a composition prompt assigns a specific type of "telling back" (such as retelling a reading as a poem, which a student may or may not have already experimented with of their own accord in their narrations). Additionally, compositions move beyond narration and variations of "telling back" to assignments which ask students to direct their attention to specific ideas within or across their readings (such as comparing and contrasting characters or texts) and other types of reflection which they previously have mainly practiced discussing orally or briefly in writing after reading and narrating in their lessons. Finally, especially as students enter high school, composition assignments merge with grammar assignments to help students understand the writing process more globally and consider aspects of style, editing, revision, research, and the ethics of communication.



Placement & Combining Tips

If your student did not do Paragraph Town last year, you should incorporate that book with the 8th-grade grammar book.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
8	Grammar/Comp: Grade 8 2 times/week 20 min 2 times/week 15 min	Grammar Voyage Grammar Voyage Teacher Manual (select pages) Practice Voyage Practice Voyage Teacher Manual (select pages)

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
Language Study: Grade 8				
Grammar/Comp: Grade 8 Written Narration:	Grammar/Comp: Grade 8 Written Narration:	Dictation: Grade 8 Written Narration: Grade 8 Copywork: Grade 8	Grammar/Comp: Grade 8 Written Narration:	Dictation: Grade 8 Grammar/Comp: Grade 8 Written Narration:



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.

Grammar/Comp: Grade 8

☐ Bookmark Grammar Voyage Teacher Manual. (Find in Quick Links)

☐ Bookmark Practice Voyage Teacher Manual. (Find in Quick Links)



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

Grammar/Comp: Grade 8



Grammar Voyage



Grammar Voyage Teacher Manual (select pages)



Practice Voyage



Practice Voyage Teacher Manual (select pages)



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)

(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

Grammar/Comp: Grade 8

∞ [Extra Helpings](#)

∞ [Grammar Voyage Teacher Manual](#)

∞ [Practice Voyage Teacher Manual](#)

∞ [Grammar Voyage Pg. Numbers/Beginning Ending Words Ebook](#)

Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.



Related Course Quick Links

∞ [Copywork & Dictation: Grade 8](#)

SAMPLE

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How To Teach Grammar

	Connect Link back to the previous lesson.
	Read Read the assigned pages and discuss new ideas. It is important for students to be able to talk about the concepts in their own words. The pictures and diagrams in the book can serve as a springboard for discussions about the grammar concepts.
	Practice Complete practice examples in the text and/or the practice book that accompany the lesson.
	Observe Observe examples of concepts in books being read and in daily life.

Grammar/Comp: Grade 8

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Term 1

WEEK 1 20m Grammar/Comp: Grade 8 - Lesson 1

→ NOTE TO STUDENTS

One purpose of composition lessons is to encourage you, the student, to dig deeper, reflect on your readings, explore the different ways words work, and learn how to ask good questions of yourself and your readings. Set your timer and use the whole time allotted for a composition assignment. If you finish an assignment with extra time, explore another perspective, ask further questions, or take a bit more time to see if any other thoughts come to mind. Alternatively, if you find yourself stuck, you may want to take a short break and come back later! Growth, not frustration, is the goal.

→ 15M COMPOSITION ASSIGNMENT #1 - SUMMARY/REFLECTION

Write a brief summary of a current event.

OR

Tell of a time when your desire for society was met. How did that experience impact/affect you?

→ 15M COMPOSITION ASSIGNMENT #2 - LETTER

Write a letter to a family member, friend, or imaginary character about one of your favorite books so far this year. Tell them what you think the book is about, why you like it so far, and then send the letter if you like!

★ TEACHER TIP

Make sure students are practicing typing skills and typing narrations and compositions regularly.

There are two designated lessons each week to work on the Composition prompts. All prompts will be listed in those lessons, so students can choose which prompts to work on.

• REFERENCE

Comp #1

Ethics: Part 2 (Lesson 1)

Book: Ourselves

WEEK 1 20m Grammar/Comp: Grade 8 - Lesson 2

Introduction

Materials: Grammar Voyage

→ RECAP

What do you remember about grammar from last year? Can you recite the eight parts of speech?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.4-9

- Note that "Intro" means into, and "duct" means lead.

→ PRACTICE

Find the end rhyme on p.5-6 and discuss what you like about the poem. Copy the 4 ways of thinking about language on p.9. Find new places on p.8-9 on a map.

WEEK 1 20m Grammar/Comp: Grade 8 - Lesson 3

Word Fragments

Materials: Grammar Voyage

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.10

→ PRACTICE

Copy the list of Latin words or word fragments into your notebook. Which ones do you already know? Which ones do you need to memorize? Work through all the words at the bottom of the page, substituting the meaning from the list for the highlighted part of the word. See if you can puzzle out how understanding the fragment's meaning sheds light on the meaning of the words.

WEEK 1 20m Grammar/Comp: Grade 8 - Lesson 4

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Term 1

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Ethics: Part 2 (Lesson 1)

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WEEK 2 20m Grammar/Comp: Grade 8 - Lesson 5

→ 15M COMPOSITION ASSIGNMENT #1 - EXPOSITORY

Tell of a time when you took a "share in the interests of the great world" by listening with all your heart to someone who shared about a profession, skill, subject, or experience with which you were unfamiliar.

→ 15M COMPOSITION ASSIGNMENT #2 - DESCRIPTIVE

From your reading in Ancient History, write a page-long interview for Sulla. What questions would you ask him?

★ TEACHER TIP

Some students may find it helpful to use external supports before writing, such as index cards that can be arranged and re-ordered. You can also encourage students to talk aloud as they write or use speech-to-text and then edit.

• REFERENCE

Comp #1

Ethics: Part 2 (Lesson 2)

Book: Ourselves

Comp #2

Ancient History (G7-9, Lesson 1)

Book: A Short History of Ancient Rome

WEEK 2 20m Grammar/Comp: Grade 8 - Lesson 6

Nouns

Materials: Grammar Voyage

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.11-17

→ PRACTICE

- Copy the diagram on p.15. Discuss the size and placement of the elements.
- For each noun in purple on p.16, is it a person, place, or thing?
- Copy the types of nouns in purple from p.17 and come up with your own example for each type. Discuss compound nouns, too.

• DEFINITIONS

A marine chronometer is a clock that is accurate enough to be used to calculate longitude via celestial navigation.

★ TEACHER NOTE

There are also COMPOUND NOUNS that combine words. They are sometimes hyphenated: mother-in-law, schoolteacher, toothpaste.

WEEK 2 20m Grammar/Comp: Grade 8 - Lesson 7

Pronouns

Materials: Grammar Voyage

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.18-21

→ PRACTICE

- Copy the charts for the two cases of pronouns on p.20.

★ TEACHER NOTE

In modern usage, they and them have been adopted as singular pronouns that can replace a singular noun. For example: In the dictation lesson, the student will choose words that are unfamiliar to "them" (instead of saying "her or him"). If your child doesn't know French, "they" can start

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Term 1

• What is the plural third-person subject pronoun? What is the singular first-person object pronoun? What is the singular and plural second person subject and object pronoun? • Copy the lists of demonstrative, possessive, interrogative, and indefinite pronouns on p.21.		learning it this year (instead of "he or she").
WEEK 2	20m Grammar/Comp: Grade 8 - Lesson 8 → 15M COMPOSITION ASSIGNMENT #1- EXPOSITORY Tell of a time when you took a "share in the interests of the great world" by listening with all your heart to someone who shared about a profession, skill, subject, or experience with which you were unfamiliar. → 15M COMPOSITION ASSIGNMENT #2- DESCRIPTIVE From your reading in Ancient History, write a page-long interview for Sulla. What questions would you ask him?	★ TEACHER TIP Some students may find it helpful to use external supports before writing, such as index cards that can be arranged and re-ordered. You can also encourage students to talk aloud as they write or use speech-to-text and then edit. • REFERENCE Comp #1 Ethics: Part 2 (Lesson 2) Book: Ourselves Comp #2 Ancient History (G7-9, Lesson 1) Book: A Short History of Ancient Rome
WEEK 3	20m Grammar/Comp: Grade 8 - Lesson 9 → 15M COMPOSITION ASSIGNMENT #1- EXPOSITORY/RESEARCH From your reading in Ourselves, compare and contrast the desire for knowledge and curiosity. → 15M COMPOSITION ASSIGNMENT #2- OPINION From your reading in current events, what do you think are some issues your country has to deal with today? Why?	★ TEACHER TIP Provide opportunities for students to explore other ways of narrating using technology with applications such as PowerPoint or design software such as Canva. • REFERENCE Comp #1 Ethics: Part 2 (Lesson 3) Book: Ourselves
WEEK 3	20m Grammar/Comp: Grade 8 - Lesson 10 <i>Pronouns, Adjectives</i> Materials: Grammar Voyage → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS p.22-27 → DISCUSS Why is it important to make sure that the pronoun's antecedent is clear? Why is it better to say "modify" instead of "describe" to explain what adjectives do? How do adjectives modify pronouns?	★ TEACHER NOTE Emphasize the word modify because it is much more accurate than the word describe. When the adjective happens, the noun goes poof. Example: LADDER and CORPORATE LADDER
WEEK 3	20m Grammar/Comp: Grade 8 - Lesson 11 <i>Articles, Review</i> Materials: Grammar Voyage → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS p.28-30 → PRACTICE • Find nouns, pronouns, and adjectives in the first paragraph of Moby Dick on p.29. [See Answer Key] Remember that articles are special	★ TEACHER TIP This would make a good small-group activity for a classroom setting, letting students work together to find as many nouns, pronouns, and adjectives as they can. This presents the opportunity to discuss items they did not see or to discuss why an item they chose is none of the three.

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Term 1

- adjectives!
- Find all the nouns in the passage on p.30. [31 of them, excluding the infinitive "to ebb"] How many are plural?

- WEEK 3** **20m Grammar/Comp: Grade 8 - Lesson 12**
→ **15M COMPOSITION ASSIGNMENT #1- EXPOSITORY/RESEARCH**
From your reading in Ourselves, compare and contrast the desire for knowledge and curiosity.
- **15M COMPOSITION ASSIGNMENT #2 - OPINION**
From your reading in current events, what do you think are some issues your country has to deal with today? Why?

- ★ **TEACHER TIP**
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- **REFERENCE**
Comp #1
Ethics: Part 2 (Lesson 3)
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SAMPLE